

Operation: Jack and Nate's Room

Overnight surprise cleanup — ~4.5 hours — Dad solo mission

The 2-second rule: if you are still deciding after 2 seconds, it donates. Keep moving.

ROOM ZONE MAP

ZONE 1 — JACK #1 Gaming Zone L-shaped desk, PS5 (hero piece), monitor, controller, cables tamed, red lantern, chair cleared	ZONE 2 — JACK #2 Pokemon Zone White credenza top — binders, tins, figures grouped. Plush cluster one end. Nothing else lives here.	ZONE 3 — SLEEP Bunk Bed Zone Lower bunk: clear + made. Upper bunk: Nate's stuffies at head, 1 blanket, done. No dumping.
ZONE 4 — NATE Lego Display Zone Dark dresser top — Technic builds + Spider-Man stay. Do NOT move or disassemble. Fragile.	ZONE 5 — BOOKS + NATE Bookcase Zone Left column keeps books. Right shelves: purge bags/junk. Lego boxes + manuals get one shelf.	ZONE 6 — STORAGE Closet Zone Ladder OUT of house. Top shelf: camping gear + extra bedding. Eye-level: backpacks. Floor: clear.

BEFORE YOU TOUCH ANYTHING — SET UP SUPPLIES (10 MIN)

Trash (3 bags) A = obvious junk, wrappers, broken stuff (center of room, main bag) B = mystery items you are 90% sure are trash C = overflow	Donate (3 boxes/bags) 1 = toys and random items 2 = outgrown books and board games 3 = clothes they will not miss
Laundry pile Pick one corner or the doorway. Every item on the floor that is clothing goes here with zero exceptions. No smell-testing.	Return to house / other rooms 1 box — the ladder goes here first. Random house items (tools, etc.) go here.

4.5-HOUR TIMELINE

Setup 10m	Floor 30m	Bunks 25m	Closet 50m	Desk+ Cables 55m	Book- case 35m	Pokemon 10m	Drawer 25m	Final 20m	

- ☐ Tent / green outdoor gear bag: goes to the "return to house" box. This never lives in a bedroom.
- ☐ Sleeping bags: keep 2 (one per boy), bag/roll the third for closet or donate it.
- ☐ Extra blankets: keep 2 total. The rest go to the hall linen closet, NOT this room.
- ☐ Extra pillows: keep 2 total. Extras out to the hall closet.
- ☐ Upper bunk end state: 1 blanket laid out, Nate's favorite stuffies grouped at the pillow end. Done.

Phase 3

Lower Bunk — Make It a Real Bed

20 min

- ☐ All clothes on the lower bunk: laundry pile.
- ☐ Backpacks: 2 daily-use ones hang on closet door or hooks near the door. The rest in the closet.
- ☐ Any bags, gear, or random items: sort to closet or donate.
- ☐ Strip and remake the lower bunk — flat sheet, blanket, one pillow at the head. Looks like a hotel bed.
- ☐ The basketball hoop on the rail: leave it. It is part of the personality.

- ☐ Hooks on closet wall or back of door: hang the 2 daily-use backpacks here.

Phase 5

Gaming Desk + PS5 Setup

55 min

Jack #1

- ☐ Clear the gaming chair first — all clothes to laundry pile. Sit down, you have earned it for 30 seconds.
- ☐ Sweep everything off the desk surface onto the floor. Clean slate first, then put back only what belongs.
- ☐ Papers: fast sort — school stuff into backpack, rest goes in Trash A. Middle schoolers' desk papers are 90% trash.
- ☐ Guitar book: goes to the bookcase. Not a desk item.
- ☐ Cable management (15-20 min — do not rush this, the result is dramatic):
 - ☐ Position power strip at the back-right of the desk against the wall.
 - ☐ Bundle PS5 power + HDMI together with a zip tie right where they leave the PS5. Run behind the monitor, not in front.
 - ☐ Route all cables along the back edge of the desk and down one desk leg to the power strip.
 - ☐ Any cable that is too long: fold the excess into a fist-size coil, zip-tie the coil, tuck behind the PS5.
- ☐ Surface layout — what goes back ON the desk:
 - ☐ Monitor (centered or slightly right), PS5 standing vertically with white faceplate facing the door, controller in its designated spot, red lantern back-left corner. Nothing else.
 - ☐ Mini fridge: move it to the floor on the left side of the desk. Off the surface.
 - ☐ Lego display builds: move to the windowsill behind the desk (if sill is wide enough) or to the bookcase. Off the desk surface.
 - ☐ The 3-drawer acrylic unit: stays on desk right side or goes on the floor beside the desk. Holds small accessories and random small items.
 - ☐ Stand at the door. PS5 faceplate should be visible. Desk should look like a gaming setup, not a junk drawer.

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Phases 6–9 + Decision Rules + The Reveal

Phase 6

Built-In Bookcase — Sort and Reload

35 min

- ☐ Left column (Star Wars, Marvel, DOAWK series): leave the books. Just straighten them upright.
- ☐ All other shelves: pull everything off onto the cleared floor.
- ☐ Drawstring bags (Star Wars, orange mesh, others): keep 1-2 if they are used. Donate the rest.
- ☐ Any books mixed in: sort — keep age-appropriate ones, donate outgrown ones to Box 2.
- ☐ Any books that came out of the closet: add them to the bookcase left column.
- ☐ Reload with intention — assign each shelf one job:
- ☐ Top 1-2 shelves: books only, standing upright with spines out.
- ☐ One middle shelf: Lego boxed sets and instruction booklets (Nate's section).
- ☐ One shelf: Jack's card overflow (extra binders or boxes that don't fit the credenza).
- ☐ Remaining shelves: leave deliberately empty or put 1 display item per shelf. Empty = clean. Random = messy.
- ☐ The "About Nate" cork board stays exactly as it is. Do not touch it.

Phase 7

Pokemon Zone — Credenza

Jack #2

15 min

- ☐ Group the card storage boxes together in a row at the back of the credenza.
- ☐ Stack the tins neatly — 2-3 tall max. Place them in one area, not scattered.
- ☐ Pokemon plush (Eevee, Bulbasaur, Pikachu, others): cluster them together in one corner of the credenza. They are a display, not scatter decoration.
- ☐ Pokemon figures: stand them in a small group near the tins. Facing outward.
- ☐ Binders: upright in a row, spine out like books.
- ☐ The Pokemon playmat can lay flat on the credenza surface as the base layer. It looks great as a display backdrop.
- ☐ Wipe the credenza surface quickly. The before vs. after here is dramatic even with a fast wipe.
- ☐ Board games (Connect Four etc.) move to a closet shelf or the bookcase bottom shelf. They are not display items.
- ☐ The tripod: lean it flat against the wall behind the credenza or in the closet. Off the floor.

Phase 8

Under-Bed Drawer — Sort and Reload

20 min

- ☐ Pull the full drawer out if possible. Dump contents on the cleared floor.
- ☐ Canteen: keep. Goes on a closet shelf or bookcase shelf.
- ☐ Small collectibles and figurines: keep ones that are clearly cared about. Donate the fast-food-toy-level stuff.
- ☐ Reload the drawer using the dividers — one section per purpose:
- ☐ Section 1: Jack's small collectibles and gaming accessories.
- ☐ Section 2: Nate's small items, Lego accessories, overflow.
- ☐ Section 3: shared items — rubber bands, loose change, whatever has no other home.
- ☐ The Lego pieces you corralled in Phase 1: they can go in a small bin in the Nate section of this drawer.

Phase 9

Final Sweep — The Reveal Setup

20 min

- ☐ Walk the perimeter of the room. Anything still on the floor that should not be there: find it a home.
- ☐ Wipe down the desk surface, the credenza top, and the top of the dresser.
- ☐ Straighten the posters (Iverson, boombox) — they are crooked in the photos.
- ☐ All donate boxes and trash bags go OUTSIDE the bedroom door tonight. They leave the house tomorrow.
- ☐ Laundry pile: move it to the laundry room or a hamper outside the door. Not their problem tonight.
- ☐ Turn on the red LED lantern on the desk. The PS5 faceplate should be visible from the doorway.
- ☐ Final check: stand at the door. Floor clear. Both beds made. PS5 as the hero. Pokemon zone curated. Lego builds displayed. Done.

KEEP / DONATE / TRASH — 2-SECOND RULES

KEEP — Touched in last 2 months, active collection (Pokemon, Lego), obvious sentimental value, functional and used.

DONATE — You do not know what it is, younger-kid toy, duplicate, missing pieces, still deciding after 2 seconds.

TRASH — Wrappers, random paper, broken with no fix, mystery object with no clear owner.

The Reveal — What He Will See When He Walks In

- PS5 standing vertically, white faceplate facing the door, red lantern glowing
- Gaming desk surface clear — monitor, controller, PS5. Nothing else.
- Pokemon zone on the credenza: cards organized, figures displayed, tins stacked, plush grouped
- Both beds made flat and clean
- Floor completely clear — no clothes, no random items, no garbage
- Nate's Lego builds still exactly where he left them on the dresser (untouched)
- Nate's stuffies at the head of the upper bunk
- The "About Nate" cork board exactly as he hung it